How much are music platforms profiting from people discovering music?

Is it profitable for music platforms if everyone just listens to songs they already know about?

How much do artists earn from music on Apple Music and Spotify?

How much would a swipe-based layout cost to sustain?

How much do AI prompt tools cost?

Whats pink for?

Whats red for?

Answers to any question, which is connected to a source/sources

Whats yellow for?

Questions related to costs and earnings

Whats blue for?

Questions related to UI features

Whats green for?

Questions related to people, their wishes, their problems

What product are we making?

A design proposal for a Music Discovery tool

https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1R7...

Concept_Art_Slideshow

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1199J9...

Project Proposal final

https://docs.google.com/document/d/159Vt-...

Music Discovery Evidence Map(2).md

https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1Pr...

Concept Art Slideshow 2.0

Who are the stakeholders?

What do platforms lose when recommendations are ignored?

Do people want more transparent options for music?

What share of released tracks actually gets listened to?

What features do users pay attention to when finding music?

What features take the least effort to work with?

How do we measure effort from the user?

What problems come with using AI for finding music?

What do discovery tabs succeed at?

What do discovery tabs fail at?

What do AI prompts help with in discovery?

Why do people discover on-platform rather than on social media or radio?

What features do people use the most for discovery?

For what reasons do people discover new music?

How often do people listen to single genres during a play-session? How about multiple genres? Multiple song moods? Multiple versions(instrumental vs lyrical)?

when do people want to hear something other than their usual rotation?

https://www.pnas.org/doi/10.1073/pnas.230...

Disrupted routines anticipate musical exploration | PNAS

Understanding and predicting the emergence and evolution of cultural tastes manifested in consumption patterns is of central interest to social sci...

https://www.cs.toronto.edu/~ashton/pubs/s...

Link

When they travel. Taste shifts toward a visited place's music when that music differs from home.

In weekly bursts, usually around December, when the holidays happen and people have more free time. The rate of how much music they discover is self-sustaining, but the cause isn't exact.

https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/13...

Music streaming, cultural consumption, and the everyday routines of algorithm management: Exploring how trust and objective setting shape everyday encounters with algorithmic systems - Victor Ávila Torres, David Beer, 2025

Algorithms are often understood to be a powerful presence in shaping everyday life. In particular, the established part that algorithmic recommendations play in...

The more the user shows repeated behaviour, the more the app adapts its algorithm to match it.

People like interacting with their music. They like to save it because it gives them a feeling of ownership.

People do have objectives when they look for new music. Thus, they have expectations(which vary in extent and specificity)

Algorithm trust and user objectives are important to finding music on apps. Many users intervene with the algorithm to get it to work in their favor.

Users reporting on interacting with autoplay

1130 words

On music platforms, autoplay is inconsistent at continuing what you liked about the song it started from.

120.5 million tracks received between zero and ten streams in 2025, out of 253 million. If casual discovery doesn't happen, that stays dark, and artists and rights holders carry the cost.(from Luminate's analysis)

GOV.UK

https://www.gov.uk/government/publication...

The impact of recommendation algorithms on the UK's music industry

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Interesting facts:

- Creators want more transparency over how recommendations work on DSPs
- Users wish they knew why recommendations were given to them
- Most users do not know how recommendations work.
- Some creators adapt their music to attract attention in the first 30 seconds
- Some creators feel that increased transparency would even the playing field
- 53% of interviewed creators changed how they release music because of recommendation algorithms.

New idea: You can check out tags describing the current song and apply them to filter the rest of recommendations. You can stack multiple tags to filter recommendations(eg. if you have "drums" and "indie", you get "indie + drums", "drums" and "indie" music.)

Then if you like your current queue you can save it to menu and check it out later.

This way users can make their own niche discovery channels and find music they enjoy more as they listen to it.

Solution

A song player that lets you control the flow of listening sessions through gesture-activated features: sample tracks before fully listening to them, change the style of incoming recommendations, and explore new genres based on the currently playing song.

User Scenarios

Problem Descriptions(1-sentence long)

Competitor Analysis

BandCamp

Every tool that lets you combine tags makes you name them before you hear anything. None lets you collect them from music as it plays.

Apple Music

Moodagent(discontinued)

EveryNoiseAtOnce

YouTube Music

Soundcloud

Discover Quickly(Spotify Experiment)

VK Music

Deezer

Lack of niche music—artists with small audiences or those unable to pay won't upload their music to Spotify.

Because of this most small artists upload to SoundCloud or BandCamp.

Music cannot be downloaded.(offline mode lets you play music without wifi and playlists can be downloaded, but you still can't export it directly in mp3/wav to your device)

Spotify issues

A subscription is required for a decent user experience—the free version is severely limited.

Discovery playlists differ only by standard filters like year, artist, title, genre, specific attributes, or curated playlists;

Personalized mixes are made automatically through daylist and Discover Weekly, which take a long time to adapt to user wishes and can't be relied on for daily use.

Clunky recommendation systems based on

the usual one-axis sorting options (popularity, date, etc.); Search by tags is hidden from casual listeners and its not even updated since last decade (“genre: rock; tag: hipster(for <1000 listen songs))

Black-box Layout: non-customizable, opaque recommendation algorithms based on unclear criteria.

track popularity (resulting in a stream of mainstream pop and generic algorithm-generated tracks);

https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1OUW...

spotify_reviews - Google Drive

Helping listeners who are open to song suggestions, not finding songs in a focused mode, actually find new material without having to answer to any specifications. Instead they discover what they wanna listen to as they go, and then when they finally are willing to specify, they have that option directly in the track itself.

Problem Analysis(5 sentences)

Discovery options make the listener spend effort before they learn whether there's anything worth hearing — describing their taste, or playing through a list to judge it, which is expected to push casual discovery off the platform or out of the session.

Current problem statement:

Music platforms take requests only in words, so a listener who can't yet name what they want is left with controls that only subtract, or with searching manually.

This leaves listeners unable to ask for what they can't name, and artists unable to be found by people who don't know them.

This is where the problem description mockup will go. Until next week on 12th, we need to find 5-8 conclusions from sources(red stuff) to support this.

Next up: Value Proposition(1 sentence)

Target Groups And User Personas(3-4)

Weak Link: We don't know if a smoother UI experience would make people enjoy discovering new music on a music platform. We don't know how often the casual listener wants to sample new music taste.

Potential Questions to ask

Strengths Weaknesses Opportunities Threats